PROJECT JEDI ORDER · ROOK DISPATCH · RELEASE 4.2 REVIEW

We cut the ping wait by 30 seconds. Four responders went silent.

What happened after 12 August, how we proved it across six modules of work, the fix we'd build, and the skills that stop it happening again.

Yoda, Rook Dispatch PM · made-up company, real working file · 7 Nov 2026 · Use ← → or the buttons below

WHAT HAPPENED, PLAINLY

4.2 cut the ping wait from 90 to 60 seconds. Responders who need a little over a minute now "miss" pings, and the routing code punishes a miss exactly like a "no", with no recovery over time.

18% from 2%

of pings missed, starting the day 4.2 shipped

64% from 77%

acceptance rate, the headline metric

~1 from ~12

pings a week for Farlight, The Undertow, Vesper and Meteor Mite

8 of 9

data-based acceptance criteria that 4.2 fails

It wasn't an "August dip". Turn-downs didn't rise, the drop starts on release day, and work moved from four people to ten others instead of falling for everyone.

HOW IT HAPPENS

A spiral nobody designed

1
Ping waits 60s
Was 90s. "On the stairs, one boot on" responders answer at ~70s.

2
Counted as a miss
The ping vanishes and goes to the next person.

3
−0.12, same as a "no"
A take only earns +0.08. The score never recovers on its own.

4
Ranked lower
Others now get asked first, even on the responder's home patch.

5
Fewer chances
Rare pings arrive out of the blue and get missed too. Back to 2.

A 2019 note in the code asked whether scores should recover over time. Nobody came back to it, so the shorter wait turned a small rule into a trap.

MODULE 1 · ORIGIN STORY · THE CONTEXT

Nobody had written down how Dispatch decides who gets pinged.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

```
>       is there a priority criteria for the pings/
```

> **Finding:** no routing weights were documented anywhere: not the wiki, not the release notes, not Priya's handoff. The only answer was in the code, which nobody on the 4.2 thread had read. Marcus's 14 Aug question about it went unanswered.

What the team had to go on before 4.2 shipped

Routing weights written down	Missing
How a missed ping is scored	Missing
Success measures for the 4.2 change (none found)	Missing
Real weekly acceptance numbers (only "rough" ones offered)	Missing
An owner for the Q3 roadmap (all items were Priya's)	Missing
Release notes listing what changed	Yes

Sources: Rook wiki, 4.2 release thread, Priya's handoff note.

MODULE 2 · SUPER HEARING · THE VOICES

The interviews and the tickets were telling different stories.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

```
 based on these responses can i get insight into
>where the issue could begiven the wide variety of
 responses in the interviews and the actual tickets
```

Finding: the four interviews and the 147 tickets came from different people. Only one handler appears in both. Interviews were loud on alerts, dark mode and text size. The tickets were loud on two things, both open and both starting with 4.2: responders who'd gone quiet, and pings gone before anyone could answer.

Callout tickets after 4.2, by theme



Source: support_tickets. All 45 open. None of these themes came up in the interviews.

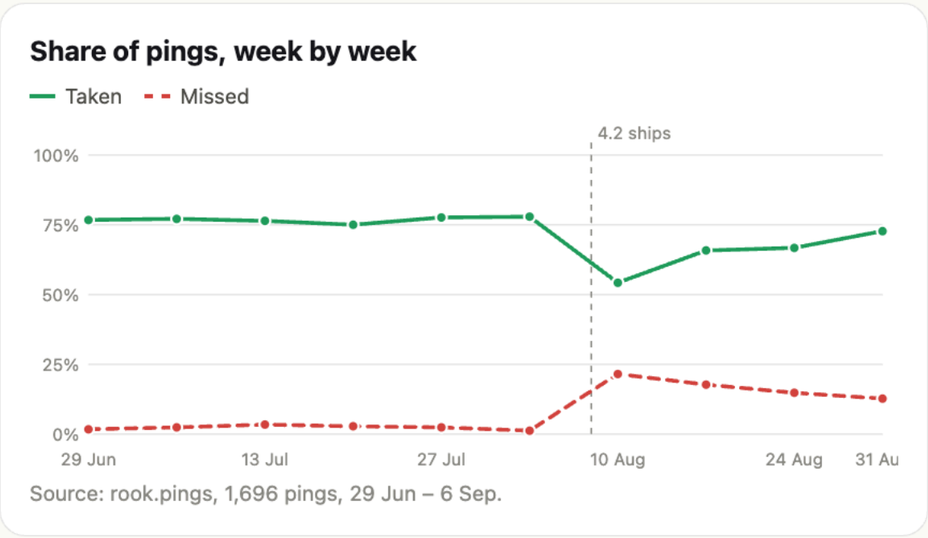
MODULE 3 · REWIND · THE NUMBERS

The day 4.2 shipped, missed pings jumped ninefold.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

```
>                    summarize what changed after 4.2
```

Finding: acceptance fell from about 77% to 64%, and almost all of it was missed pings: 2% before, 18% after, starting on 12 Aug itself. Turn-downs didn't rise (21% to 18%). Callouts nobody took doubled, from 5.5% to 11%.



MODULE 4 · X-RAY VISION · THE CODE

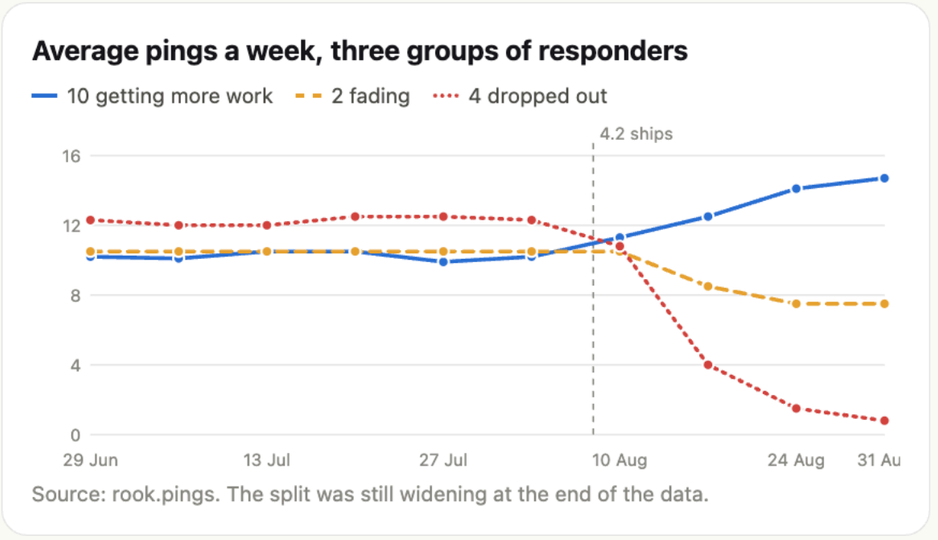
The scoring formula explains who went quiet.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

> WHATS THE SCORING FORMULA

Closeness 60%	Said yes lately 25	Skills 15%

Finding: a miss costs −0.12, the same as a "no"; a take earns +0.08; the score never resets. The responders who took the biggest hit in week one (The Undertow −0.72, Meteor Mite −0.56, Farlight −0.44) were the ones who went quiet.



Source: rook.pings. The split was still widening at the end of the data.

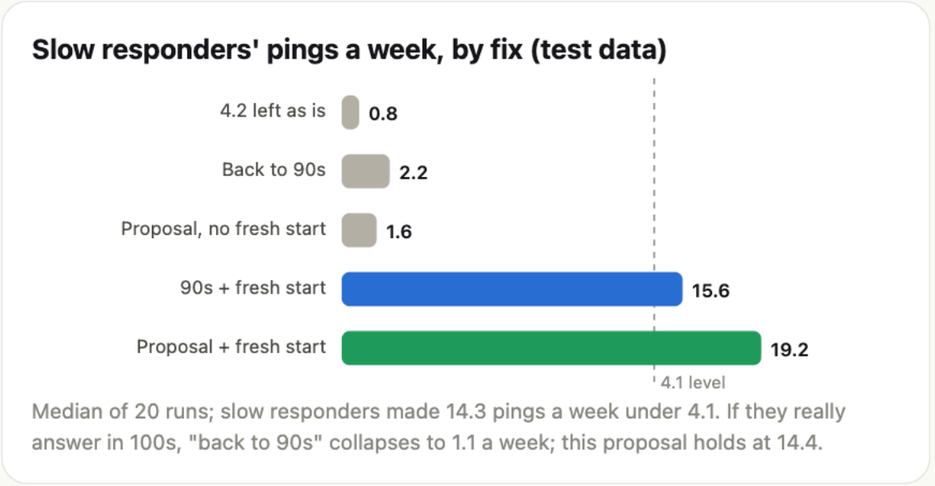
MODULE 5 · SUPER SPEED · THE FIX

Keep 60 seconds, change what happens around it.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

```
> Can you create a solution brief to fix the issue
while keeping the 60s response time?
```

Artifact: `05-super-speed/brief.md`. The ping stays open after 60 seconds (the first yes wins), being late is no longer a "no", and every score gets one fresh start. Stress-tested on 20 runs: **no fix works without the fresh start**, not even going back to 90 seconds.



MODULE 6 · SIDEKICKS · THE TEST

Judged by its own data, 4.2 fails 8 of 9 criteria.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

```
> based on the data we have can you generate an
acceptance criteria and also test 4.2
```

> **Finding:** each limit is the worst normal week before 4.2. Even 4.2's own promise failed: pings were meant to move on *sooner*, but reaching the responder who takes the job went from about 26 seconds to 61.

Weeks after release (✓ pass, ✕ fail)

Criterion	10 Aug	17 Aug	24 Aug	31 Aug
AC1 Taken ≥ 75%	54.2% ✕	65.8% ✕	66.7% ✕	72.7% ✕
AC2 Missed ≤ 3.5%	21.5% ✕	17.7% ✕	14.8% ✕	12.7% ✕
AC3 Turned down ≤ 23%	24.3% ✕	16.5% ✓	18.5% ✓	14.5% ✓
AC4 Nobody took it ≤ 8.3%	12.7% ✕	14.0% ✕	12.9% ✕	5.5% ✓
AC5 Pings per callout ≤ 1.26	1.61 ✕	1.31 ✕	1.31 ✕	1.30 ✕
AC6 Reach the taker ≤ 29 s	61 s ✕	61 s ✕	61 s ✕	40 s ✕
AC7 Nobody below half	0 ✓	4 ✕	4 ✕	4 ✕
AC8 Nobody above 1.5×	0 ✓	0 ✓	1 ✕	2 ✕
AC9 Callout tickets ≤ 1	7 ✕	11 ✕	15 ✕	10 ✕

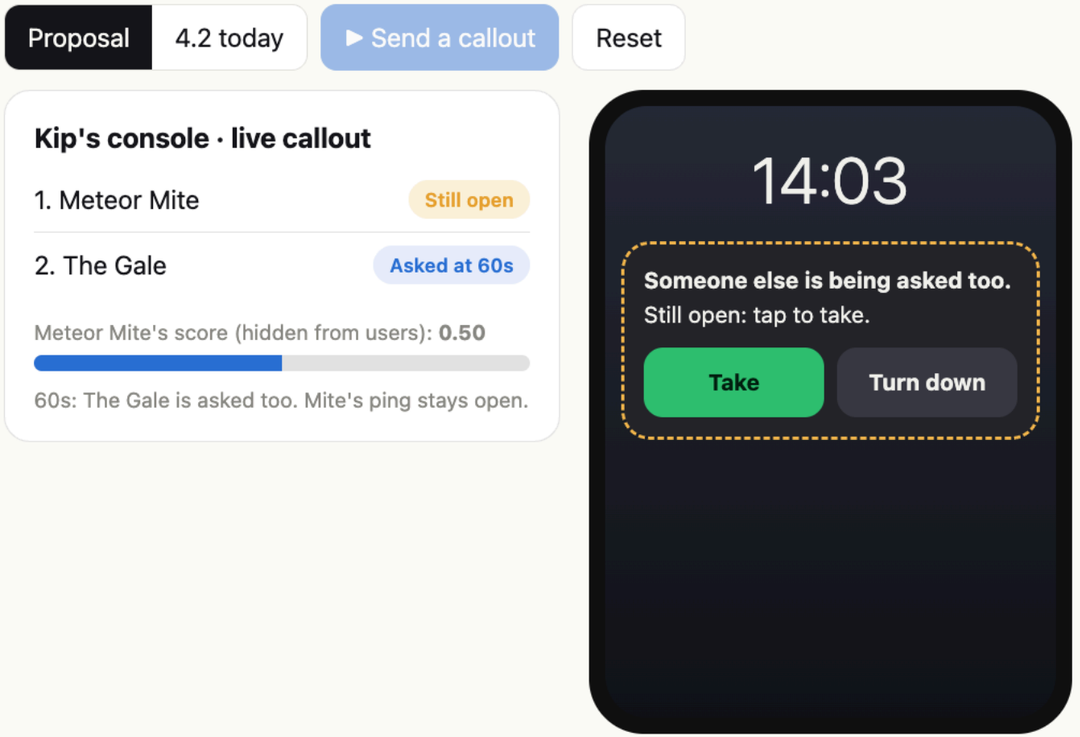
Source: `dispatch-4.2-acceptance-test.md`. AC3 turn-downs is the only one that recovers.

THE FIX, THROUGH MY PROTOTYPE

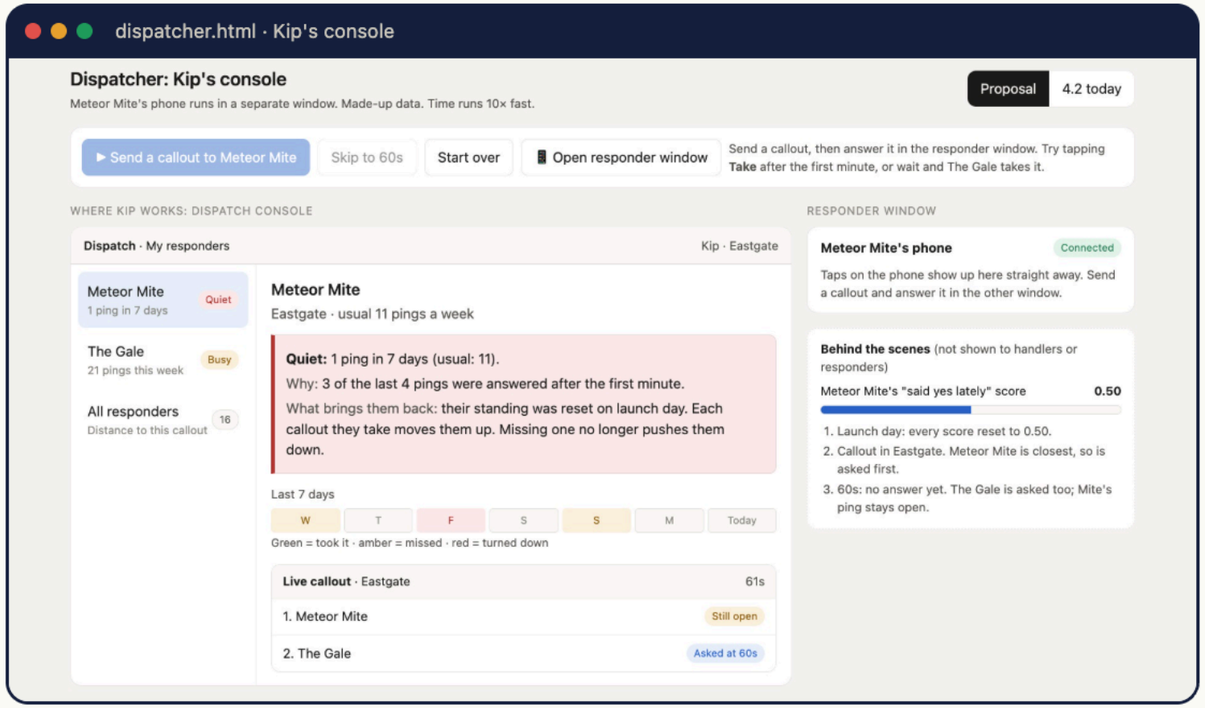
Try it: send a callout to Meteor Mite.

A mini version you can play with right here. Kip's console and Mite's phone. In **Proposal** mode, wait past 60s and the ping stays open; a late take still counts. Switch to **4.2 today** and the same ping vanishes and costs Mite 0.12.

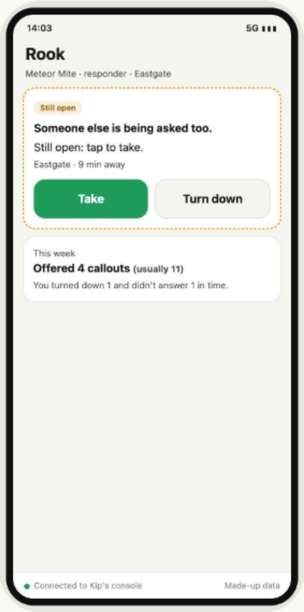
The full versions: dispatcher.html + responder.html (two windows), prototype.html, prototype-mobile.html. Open this file from the course folder for the links to work.



THE PROTOTYPE I BUILT: TWO WINDOWS, TALKING TO EACH OTHER



Dispatcher screen. Kip sees the quiet alert, the plain reason, what brings Mite back, and the live callout: Mite's ping still open at 61s, The Gale asked too.



Responder screen. At the same moment, Mite's phone says "Still open: tap to take" instead of vanishing.

MY PROMPT, EXACTLY AS TYPED

```
> give me 2 different browser windows for dispatcher and
responder instead of one
```

Open dispatcher.html, press "📱 Open responder window", send a callout and answer it on the phone: taps show up on Kip's console straight away. Both screens are captured from the real files.

KEEPING IT FROM HAPPENING AGAIN

No success measures for 4.2 could be found, and the real weekly numbers went unchecked for weeks. My skills close both gaps.

Before shipping

review-checklist + fix-brief

Every brief must name an owner, say how we'll know it worked, keep its scope, and explain the problem first. fix-brief proposes the edits and waits for my approval.

MY PROMPT

```
> yes fix the brief and make it a skill to fix these type of things when we prepare a brief going forward
```

On my own brief: 0 of 4 checks passed → 4 of 4 after the fixes.

Every Monday

weekly-trends

Pulls the pings and tickets, compares before 4.2, after 4.2 and after the fix, and scores AC1–AC9. Scheduled to run every week.

MY PROMPT

```
> create a skill to display trends every week before and after the fix. And this needs to run every week.
```

What it would have caught

Week one, not week six

Run on Monday 17 Aug, the report would already have shown:

2/9
criteria passing

21.5%
missed (limit 3.5%)

Instead the team waited for September, calling it an "August dip".

WHAT I NEED NEXT

Approve the fix, and watch it every Monday.

Helen

Approve the proposal (or 90s plus a fresh start), and accept the time-to-accept guardrail in place of requirement B3.

Wen · Marcus

Confirm scores can be reset, size the change, and agree a one-region rollout with a rollback trigger.

Ravi · Nadia

Log answer times and a "covered" outcome; refresh the pings data (it stops at 6 Sep); confirm ticket baselines.

Success is four quiet responders back above 6 pings a week within 4 weeks, missed pings at 3% or less, and all nine criteria passing for four Mondays in a row.